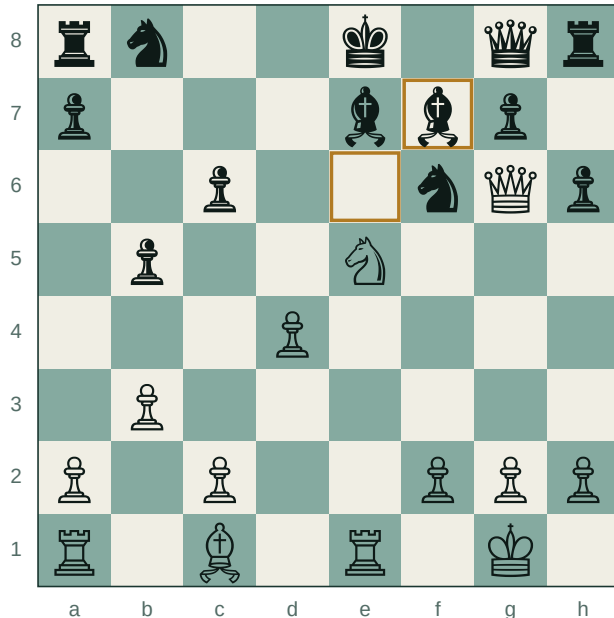


Attraction tactics: White, move 16

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 15...Bf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16. Nxf7 Qxf7 17. Rxe7+ Kxe7 18. Ba3+ Kd8 19. Qxf7

16.Nxf7 The knight captures the bishop on f7. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the bishop on e7.
Recorded reply: **16...Qxf7**.

17.Rxe7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From e7 it attacks king on e8 and queen on f7. Recorded reply: **17...Kxe7**.

18.Ba3+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **18...Kd8**.

19.Qxf7 The queen captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -4 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: bishop on f7.